



Your First Week After Cataract Surgery

What to expect, what to do, and when to call

The first week after cataract surgery is the most important part of your recovery. Your eye is healing, your vision is improving, and the steps you take during this time protect your result. **Most patients are pleasantly surprised by how quickly they feel normal again.** Here is what to expect day by day.

Day by Day: What to Expect

1 Surgery Day

Mild scratchiness, light sensitivity, and slightly blurry vision are normal. Rest at home, wear your eye shield, and avoid touching your eye.

2 Day One Follow-Up

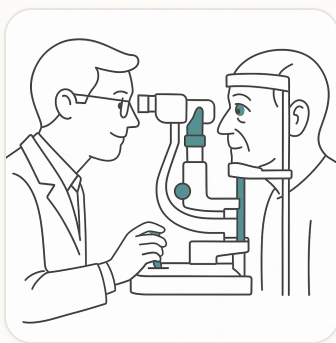
Most patients notice improved vision by the next morning. We check your eye, confirm healing is on track, and review your drop schedule.

3 Days Two Through Four

Vision continues to sharpen. You may resume light activities like walking, reading, and watching television. Keep using your drops as directed.

4 Days Five Through Seven

Most patients feel nearly normal. Many are cleared to drive within the first week. Your one-week visit confirms everything is healing well.



Regular follow-up visits ensure your eye is healing properly

Important Rules for Recovery

- ✓ **Use Your Eye Drops**
Your drop schedule prevents infection and controls inflammation. Follow it exactly, even when your eye feels fine.
- ✓ **Wear Your Eye Shield**
Sleep with the protective shield for the first week. It prevents accidental rubbing or pressure while you sleep.
- ✓ **Avoid Water in the Eye**
No swimming, hot tubs, or direct water in the eye for the first week. Shower carefully and avoid getting soap or water in your eye.
- ✓ **No Heavy Lifting**
Avoid bending, straining, or lifting anything heavy for the first week. This protects the healing incision.
- ✓ **Do Not Rub Your Eye**
Even if it feels itchy or irritated, rubbing can displace the lens implant or introduce bacteria. Resist the urge.

When to Call Our Office

Contact us immediately if you experience sudden vision loss, increasing pain that is not relieved by over-the-counter medication, heavy discharge or bleeding, or new flashing lights or a curtain-like shadow in your vision. These are rare but require prompt attention. When in doubt, call. We would always rather hear from you.

Normal vs. Concerning

Mild redness, slight scratchiness, and minor fluctuations in vision during the first week are normal. Severe pain, sudden decrease in vision, or significant swelling are not normal. Trust your instincts. If something feels wrong, call us right away.

Questions for Your Follow-Up Visits

- Is my eye healing on schedule?
- When can I resume exercise and normal activities?
- How long do I need to continue using eye drops?
- When can I stop wearing the eye shield at night?
- When will my vision stabilize enough for new glasses?
- When can I drive safely?

Questions During Recovery?

Our team is here to support you through every step of your healing process. Never hesitate to reach out.

760.340.4700
CALL ANYTIME

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